

ST211 Individual Non-Technical Report

Candidate Number: 48372

This study examined responses from a large, representative survey of adults in England and Scotland to understand people with which characteristics are most likely to become problem gamblers. This study primarily focuses on factors related to the socio-economics sphere: income, education, and economic activities, and their impact on influencing people's gambling behaviors.

Most income-related factors do not significantly influence people's gambling behaviors. There is little evidence suggesting that total household income, whatever measurement method applied, is related to gambling behaviors. Likewise, most income-related factors, including "income support", "no income situation", "economic activity status", "house tenure situation", and "household type" are very likely not to drive one person into becoming a gambler. The only income-related factor that may influence gambling behavior is the number of cars per household, in which it is found that when household cars increase from one to two, the probability of becoming a problem gambler would decrease by roughly 20%.

However, in contrast, 2 factors related to education: 1) the highest qualification, and 2) the age finishing full time education, are closely related to gambling behaviors. It is found that people who hold a university degree are 25.9% more unlikely to become problem gamblers compared to people holding A/GCSE qualifications. Similarly, compared to people who finish full time education at the age between 15-18, those finishing before 14 are 44.9% more likely to become gamblers, and those who finish after 19 are 88.9% less likely to become.

Another finding is lifestyle can also heavily influence people's gambling behavior. When people consume more alcohol, they are more likely to gamble. People with mental health issues are also more likely to become gamblers. A similar situation also appears in smoking, compared to people who never smoked before, people who currently smoke are 26.8% more likely to gamble. Also, the most unexpected fact is: the relationship between being Buddhists and gambling is very significant, in which Buddhists are 4.4 times more likely to become problem gamblers compared to atheists. Apart from that, age and gender also have very close relationships to gambling. Compared to males, females are 68.4% less likely to become problem gamblers; when the age increases, the probability of gambling ascends as well.

In conclusion, there is no evidence suggesting income is closely related to gambling, while factors related to lifestyle, education, gender and age indeed influence the possibility of becoming problem gamblers.